Out-of-network: Under a Self Only enrollment, the deductible is considered satisfied, and benefits are payable for you when your covered expenses applied to the calendar year deductible for your enrollment reach $2,000. Under the Self Plus One or the Self and Family enrollments, once the calendar year deductible amount of $2,000 is satisfied for an individual, covered benefits are payable for that individual; the calendar year deductible is met for all family members when the covered expenses accumulated to the calendar year deductible for any combination of family members reaches the Self Plus One or the Self and Family limit of $4,000. Only plan allowance paid for services or supplies from out-of-network providers counts toward this amount.

If the billed amount (or the Plan allowance that providers we contract with have agreed to accept as payment in full) is less than the remaining portion of your deductible, you pay the lower amount.

Example: If the billed amount is $100, the in-network provider has an agreement with us to accept $80, and you have not paid any amount toward meeting your calendar year deductible, you must pay $80. We will apply $80 to your deductible. We will begin paying benefits once the remaining portion of your calendar year deductible has been satisfied.

Note: If you change plans during Open Season and the effective date of your new plan is after January 1 of the next year, you do not have to start a new deductible under your prior plan between January 1 and the effective date of your new plan. If you change plans at another time during the year, you must begin a new deductible under your new plan.

If you change enrollment options in this Plan during the year, we will credit the amount of covered expenses already applied toward the deductible of your old option to the deductible of your new option.

Coinsurance

Coinsurance is the percentage of our allowance that you must pay for your care. Coinsurance does not begin until you have met your calendar year deductible. We will base this percentage on either the billed charge or the Plan allowance, whichever is less.

Example: Under the High Option, you pay 20% (or 25% under the Standard Option) of our allowance for in-network office visits.

If your provider routinely waives your cost

If your provider routinely waives (does not require you to pay) your copayments, deductibles, or coinsurance, the provider is misstating the fee and may be violating the law. In this case, when we calculate our share, we will reduce the provider's fee by the amount waived.

For example, under High Option, if your physician ordinarily charges $100 for a service but routinely waives your 20% coinsurance. The contracted rate is $65. We will pay $52 (80% of the actual charge of $65).

Waivers

In some instances, a provider may ask you to sign a "waiver" prior to receiving care. This waiver may state that you accept responsibility for the total charge for any care that is not covered by your health plan. If you sign such a waiver, whether or not you are responsible for the total charge depends on the contracts that the Plan has with its providers. If you are asked to sign this type of waiver, please be aware that if benefits are denied for the services, you could be legally liable for the related expenses. If you would like more information about waivers, please contact us at 800-821-6136 or write to G.E.H.A Enrollment, PO Box 21262, Eagan, MN 55121.

Differences between our allowance and the bill

Our "Plan allowance" is the amount we use to calculate our payment for covered services. Fee-for-service plans arrive at their allowances in different ways, so their allowances vary. For more information about how we determine our Plan allowance, see the definition of Plan allowance in Section 10.

Often, the provider's bill is more than a fee-for-service plan's allowance. Whether or not you have to pay the difference between our allowance and the bill will depend on the provider you use.